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PORTABLE HAPTIC SYSTEMS FOR USE WITHIN A VENUE

Abstract

Systems, methods, and apparatuses disclosed herein can generate vibrations in relation to, for example, synchronous with, audio that is associated with an event being hosted at a venue. These systems, methods, and apparatuses can generate the vibrations at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to provide physical sensations to an audience within the venue as the audience is viewing the event. These physical sensations can provide new immersive experiences to the audience as the audience is viewing the event. These systems, methods, and apparatuses can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to seats within the venue. The vibrations generated by these systems, methods, and apparatuses can propagate through the seats onto the audience to provide the new immersive experiences to the audience as the audience is viewing the event. These systems, methods, and apparatuses can be attached to the seats at the start of the event and can thereafter be de-attached, or removed, from the seats at the conclusion of the event.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/988,474, filed on Nov. 16, 2022, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

[0002] The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) is a civil rights law that prohibits discrimination based on disability. Title III of the ADA is directed toward public accommodations and commercial facilities. Under this title, “[n]o individual shall be discriminated against on the basis of disability in the full and equal enjoyment of the goods, services, facilities, privileges, advantages, or accommodations of any place of public accommodation by any person who owns, leases (or leases to), or operates a place of public accommodation.” Public accommodations, under the ADA, include “a motion picture house, theater, concert hall, stadium, or other place of exhibition or entertainment” and “an auditorium, convention center, lecture hall, or other place of public gathering.” The ADA requires new public accommodations to be accessible to people with disabilities so they, their families, and friends can enjoy equal access to entertainment, recreation, and leisure.

[0003] To be to be ADA-compliant, public accommodations are required to have wheelchair accessible seating with at least one percent of the seating is to be wheelchair seating locations. The wheelchair seating locations are to provide lines of sight comparable to those provided to other spectators. These wheelchair seating locations are to be open, level spaces that accommodate people using wheelchairs and have smooth, stable, and slip-resistant surfaces. These wheelchair seating locations are to be an integral part of the seating plan so that people using wheelchairs are not isolated from other spectators or their friends or family. Moreover, companion seats are to be provided next to the wheelchair seating locations to accommodate friend or companion of the people using wheelchairs. The wheelchair seating locations are to be provided in all areas including sky boxes and specialty areas. And, whenever more than three hundred (300) seats are provided, wheelchair seating locations are to be provided in more than one location to provide choices of admission prices and views comparable to those for the general public. The wheelchair seating locations are to be on accessible routes that provide access from parking and transportation areas and that connects to all public areas, including concessions, restaurants, rest rooms, public telephones, and exits.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS/FIGURES

[0004] The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated herein and form a part of the specification, illustrate the present disclosure and, together with the description, further serve to explain the principals thereof and to enable a person skilled in the pertinent art to make and use the same. In the drawings:

[0005] FIG. 1 illustrates a pictorial representation of an exemplary venue in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0006] FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C illustrate pictorial representations of an exemplary portable haptic device in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0007] FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B illustrate pictorial representations of an exemplary Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) compliant portable haptic device in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0008] FIG. 4 illustrates a pictorial representation of an exemplary haptic device that can be implemented within the exemplary portable haptic devices in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0009] FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F illustrate pictorial representations of exemplary mechanical coupling assemblies that can be implemented within the exemplary portable haptic devices in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0010] FIG. 6 graphically illustrates a first exemplary operation of the exemplary portable haptic devices in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure;

[0011] FIGS. 7A and 7B graphically illustrates a second exemplary operation of the exemplary portable haptic devices in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure; and

[0012] FIG. 8 graphically illustrates a simplified block diagram of a computer system that can be utilized to implement electronic devices within the exemplary venue according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0013] In the accompanying drawings, like reference numbers indicate identical or functionally similar elements. Additionally, the left most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the drawing in which the reference number first appears.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0014] The following disclosure provides many different embodiments, or examples, for implementing different features of the provided subject matter. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact, and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. In addition, the present disclosure may repeat reference numerals and/or letters in the examples. This repetition does not in itself dictate a relationship between the embodiments and/or configurations discussed.

Overview

[0015] Systems, methods, and apparatuses disclosed herein can generate vibrations in relation to, for example, synchronous with, audio that is associated with an event being hosted at a venue. These systems, methods, and apparatuses can generate the vibrations at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to provide physical sensations to an audience within the venue as the audience is viewing the event. These physical sensations can provide new immersive experiences to the audience as the audience is viewing the event. These systems, methods, and apparatuses can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to seats within the venue. The vibrations generated by these systems, methods, and apparatuses can propagate through the seats onto the audience to provide the new immersive experiences to the audience as the audience is viewing the event. These systems, methods, and apparatuses can be attached to the seats at the start of the event and can thereafter be de-attached, or removed, from the seats at the conclusion of the event.

Exemplary Venue

[0016] FIG. 1 illustrates a pictorial representation of an exemplary venue in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 1, a venue **100** represents a location for hosting an event. For example, the venue **100** can represent

a music venue, for example, a music theater, a music club, and/or a concert hall, a sporting venue, for example, an arena, a convention center, and/or a stadium, and/or any other suitable venue that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. The event can represent a musical event, a theatrical event, a sporting event, a motion picture, and/or any other suitable event that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

[0017] In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 1, the venue **100** includes one or more seating sections **102.1** through **102.d** to seat an audience to view the event. In some embodiments, the seating sections **102.1** through **102.d** represent different seating sections at different heights for viewing the event. As illustrated in FIG. 1, the seating section **102.1** represents a lower seating section for viewing the event and the seating section **102.d** represents an upper seating section above the seating section **102.1** for viewing the event. The seating sections **102.1** through **102.d** include rows of seats **104.1** through **104.e** for seating the audience to view the event. In some embodiments, the rows of seats **104.1** through **104.e** represent different rows of seats at different heights for viewing the event. As illustrated in FIG. 1, the row of seats **104.1** represents a lower row of seats for viewing the event and the row of seats **104.e** represents an upper row of seats above the row of seats **104.1** for viewing the event. As illustrated in FIG. 1, the rows of seats **104.1** through **104.e** include seats **106.1** through **106.f** for seating the audience to view the event.

Exemplary Portable Haptic Device

[0018] FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C illustrate pictorial representations of an exemplary portable haptic device in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. Generally, haptic technology refers to technologies that can generate forces, vibrations, or motions to provide physical sensations to an audience as the audience is viewing an event in a venue, such as the venue **100** as described above in FIG. 1 to provide an example. Haptic feedback, or simply haptics, as illustrated in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C refers to a type of haptics technology that generates controlled vibrations at one or more frequencies over one or more intervals in time to provide physical sensations to the audience as the audience is viewing the event. As illustrated in FIG. 2A, a portable haptic device **200** can generate vibrations **202** at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to provide the physical sensations to the audience as the audience is viewing the event. In some embodiments, these physical sensations can provide new immersive experiences to the audience as the audience is viewing the event. As to be described in further detail below, the event can include an image or a series of images, often referred to as video, and audio that is associated with the image, or the video. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can generate the vibrations **202** in relation to, for example, synchronous with, the audio that is associated with the image, or the video. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can generate the vibrations **202** to be synchronous with the lowest sounds of the audio, often referred to as bass sounds between approximately sixteen (16) Hz and approximately two hundred fifty-six (256) Hz to provide an example. For example, the portable haptic device **200** can generate vibrations **202** between four (4) Hertz (Hz) and one hundred twenty-five (125) Hz to simulate the rumbling of audio of thunder as the audience is viewing a thunderstorm within the venue.

[0019] As illustrated in FIG. 2B, the portable haptic device **200** can include a haptic device **204**, a mechanical mounting assembly **206**, and a mechanical coupling assembly **208**. Although the portable haptic device **200** is illustrated in FIG. 2B as including multiple, discrete components, those skilled in the relevant art(s) will recognize that one or more of these components can be combined without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. For example, the mechanical mounting assembly **206** and the mechanical coupling assembly **208** can be combined into a single mechanical assembly as will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. The haptic device **204** generates the vibrations **202** at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to provide the physical sensation to the member of the audience as the audience is viewing the event. In some

embodiments, the haptic device **204** can include a tactile transducer, an eccentric rotating mass vibration (ERMV) motor, a linear resonant actuator (LRA), and/or a piezo haptics sensor to provide some examples.

[0020] The mechanical mounting assembly **206** can be mechanically coupled to the haptic device **204** and the mechanical coupling assembly **208** can be mechanically coupled to the mechanical mounting assembly **206**. In some embodiments, the haptic device **204** can be mechanically connected to the mechanical mounting assembly **206** and/or the mechanical mounting assembly **206** can be mechanically connected to the mechanical coupling assembly **208** using one or more mechanical fasteners, such as nuts, screws, bolts, rivets, pins, and/or lags to provide some examples. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 2B, the vibrations **202** generated by the portable haptic device **200** can propagate through the mechanical mounting assembly **206** and/or the mechanical coupling assembly **208**. In some embodiments, the mechanical mounting assembly **206** and/or the mechanical coupling assembly **208** can vibrate at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time as the vibrations **202** propagate through the mechanical mounting assembly **206** and/or the mechanical coupling assembly **208**. In some embodiments, the mechanical mounting assembly **206** and/or the mechanical coupling assembly **208** can be constructed using one or more metallic elements, for example, copper, aluminum, one or more metallic compounds, one or more metallic mixtures, or alloys, such as steel to provide an example, and/or any other suitable metallic material that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the mechanical mounting assembly **206** and/or the mechanical coupling assembly **208** can be constructed using one or more synthetic or semi-synthetic organic compounds or materials, such as plastic and/or fiberglass to provide some examples, one or more organic materials, such as carbon fiber to provide an example, and/or any other suitable non-metallic material that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

[0021] As illustrated in FIG. 2C, a portable haptic system **212** can include the portable haptic device **200** mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to a seat **210**. Generally, the seat **210** can represent a permanent seat within the venue, such as a seat within a telescopic platform, a fixed seat, a suite seat, or the like to provide some examples, or a temporary seat within the venue, such as a portable stadium seat, a folding portable seat, a portable theater/auditorium seat, a foldable portable stool, a wheelchair, or the like to provide some examples. In some embodiments, the seat **210** can represent an exemplary embodiment of one or more of the seats **106.1** through **106.f** within the rows of seats **104.1** through **104.e** within the one or more seating sections **102.1** through **102.d** as described above in FIG. 1. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 2C, the vibrations **202** generated by the portable haptic device **200** as described above in FIG. 2A can propagate through the seat **210** onto a member of the audience that is seated in the seat **210** to provide the physical sensation to the member of the audience as the member of the audience is viewing the event. From the example above, the portable haptic device **200** can generate vibrations **202** between four (4) Hz and one hundred twenty-five (125) Hz to simulate the rumbling of audio of thunder. In this example, the vibrations **202** between four (4) Hz and one hundred twenty-five (125) Hz propagate through the seat **210** onto the member of the audience that is seated in the seat **210** to provide the physical sensation of rumbling thunder to the member of the audience as the member of the audience is viewing the thunderstorm within the venue.

[0022] In some embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be permanently attached to the seat **210** to form the portable haptic system **212**. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** and the seat **210** can together form a mechanical joint, also referred to as a sliding fit or a push fit, that enables the portable haptic device **200** to slide onto the seat **210** to form the portable haptic system **212**. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be attached to the seat using one or more mechanical fasteners, such as nuts, screws, bolts, rivets, pins, and/or lags to provide some examples, and can thereafter be de-attached, or removed, from the seat **210** by removing the

one or more mechanical fasteners. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be attached to the seat **210** by sliding onto the seat **210**, for example, at the start of the event, then attaching the portable haptic device **200** to the seat **210** using the one or more mechanical fasteners. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be de-attached from the seat **210** by removing the one or more mechanical fasteners then sliding the portable haptic device **200** from the seat **210**, for example, at the conclusion of the event.

[0023] In some embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be temporarily attached to the seat **210** to form the portable haptic system **212**. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** and the seat **210** can together form a mechanical joint, also referred to as a sliding fit or a push fit, that enables the portable haptic device **200** to slide onto the seat **210** to form the portable haptic system **212**. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** is held to the seat **210** by friction once the portable haptic device **200** is attached to the seat **210**. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be characterized as being as closely sliding, sliding, precision running, closely running, medium running, free running, and/or loosely running onto the seat **210**. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be attached to the seat and can thereafter be de-attached, or removed, from the seat **210** without suffering any permanent damage to the seat **210**. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be attached to the seat **210** by sliding onto the seat **210**, for example, at the start of the event. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be de-attached from the seat **210** by sliding from the seat **210**, for example, at the conclusion of the event without suffering any permanent damage to the seat **210**. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device **200** can be temporarily secured to the seat **210**, for example, using one or more mechanical fasteners, such as hook-and-loop fasteners and/or tie-down straps to provide some examples.

Exemplary Ada Complaint Portable Haptic Device

[0024] Referring back to FIG. **1** above, the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) requires the venue **100** to be accessible to people with disabilities so they, their families, their companions, and/or friends can enjoy equal access to the event. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. **1**, the venue **100** can include one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations to be ADA-compliant. Generally, the one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations can be located on one or more accessible routes within the venue **100** that provide access from parking and transportation areas and/or that provide access to public areas within the venue **100**, such as concessions, restaurants, rest rooms, public telephones, and/or exits to provide some examples. In some embodiments, the one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations can be arranged within the venue **100** to have lines of sight comparable to those provided to other spectators. In these embodiments, for example, where spectators can be expected to stand during the event, the one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations can provide lines of sight over standing spectators and over the shoulders of the persons standing in the row immediately in front and over the heads of the persons standing two rows in front. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. **1**, the number of wheelchair accessible seating locations from among the one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations can be at least one (1) percent of the available seating to be ADA-compliant. In some embodiments, for example, when the venue **100** includes more than 300 available seats, the one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations can be dispersed among different locations within the venue, such as within different seating sections from among the sections **102.1** through **102.d** to provide an example. In some embodiments, the one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations can be dispersed among the different locations to provide a choice of admission prices and views comparable to those for the general public. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. **1**, a person with a disability can view the event from a wheelchair that is placed within one of these wheelchair accessible seating locations. And as to be described in further detail below, the portable haptic device **200** can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the wheelchair to provide a physical sensation to the person with the disability as the person with the disability is

viewing the event.

[0025] FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B illustrate pictorial representations of an exemplary Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) compliant portable haptic device in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. As described above, the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) requires a venue, such as the venue **100** as described above in FIG. 1 to provide an example, be accessible to people with disabilities so they, their families, their companions, and/or friends can enjoy equal access to the event. In the exemplary embodiments illustrated in FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B, the venue can include one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations to be ADA-compliant. As to be described in further detail below, a person with a disability can view the event from a wheelchair **304** that is placed within one of these wheelchair accessible seating locations. In some embodiments, a portable haptic device **302** can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the wheelchair **304** in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C. In some embodiments, vibrations generated by the portable haptic device **302** can propagate through the wheelchair **304** onto the person with the disability to provide a physical sensation to the person with the disability as the person with the disability is viewing the event. In these embodiments, this physical sensation can provide the person with the disability with a similar new immersive experience as the audience is viewing the event as other members of the audience that is seated in the venue as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C to be ADA-compliant. The portable haptic device **302** and the wheelchair **304** can represent exemplary embodiments of the portable haptic device **200** and the seat **210**, respectively, as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C.

[0026] As illustrated in FIG. 3A, the portable haptic device **302** can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the wheelchair **304** in a substantially similar manner as the portable haptic device **100** as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C to form a portable haptic device system **306**. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device **302** can be temporarily attached to the wheelchair **304** to form the portable haptic device system **306**. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **302** can be attached onto the wheelchair **304** at the start of the event. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **302** can be attached onto the wheelchair **304** without suffering any permanent damage to the wheelchair **304**. This beneficially allows the person with the disability to use their own personal wheelchair to view the event from one of these wheelchair accessible seating locations without suffering any permanent damage to their own personal wheelchair. In some embodiments, vibrations generated by the portable haptic device **302** can propagate through the portable haptic device **302** onto the person with the disability that is seated in the wheelchair **304** to provide the physical sensation to the person with the disability as the person with the disability is viewing the event. And as illustrated in FIG. 3B, the portable haptic device system **306** can be mechanically decoupled, for example, de-attached. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device **302** can be mechanically decoupled, for example, de-attached, from the portable haptic device **302** as illustrated in FIG. 3B. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **302** can be de-attached from the wheelchair **304** at the conclusion of the event. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device **302** can be de-attached from the wheelchair **304** without suffering any permanent damage to the wheelchair **304**.

Exemplary Haptic Device that can be Implemented within the Exemplary Portable Haptic Devices

[0027] FIG. 4 illustrates a pictorial representation of an exemplary haptic device that can be implemented within the exemplary portable haptic devices in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 4, a haptic device **400** can generate vibrations, such as the vibrations **102** as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C to provide an example, to provide a physical sensation to a member of an audience as the audience is viewing the event in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C. In some embodiments, the haptic device **400** can be implemented using a tactile transducer, also referred to as a bass shaker. The tactile transducer represents a type

of linear resonant actuator (LRA) that oscillates about one or more principal axes, such as the x-axis, the y-axis, and/or the z-axis of the Cartesian coordinate system to provide some examples, to generate the vibrations. As illustrated in FIG. 4, the haptic device 400 includes a mechanical housing 402 and a moveable plate 404. The haptic device 400 can represent an exemplary embodiment of the haptic device 204 as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C.

[0028] In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 4, the haptic device 400 includes one or more pistons which are driven by one or more voice coils within the mechanical housing 402. The one or more voice coils can exert force on the one or more pistons that are coupled to the moveable plate 404 to cause the moveable plate 404 to oscillate, for example, move back and forth, along the one or more principal axes to generate the vibrations. As described above, the event can include an image or a series of images, often referred to as video, and audio that is associated with the image, or the video. In some embodiments, the haptic device 400 can generate the vibrations in relation to, for example, synchronous with, the audio that is associated with the image, or the video. In these embodiments, the audio can be within the lowest sounds of the audio, often referred to as bass sounds between approximately sixteen (16) Hz and approximately two hundred fifty-six (256) Hz to provide an example. In some embodiments, the audio can cause these voice coils to oscillate, for example, move back and forth, along the one or more principal axes. In these embodiments, this oscillation of the one or more voice coils can cause the moveable plate 404 to similarly oscillate along the one or more principal axes to generate the vibrations.

Exemplary Mechanical Coupling Assemblies that can be Implemented within the Exemplary Portable Haptic Devices

[0029] FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F illustrate pictorial representations of exemplary mechanical coupling assemblies that can be implemented within the exemplary portable haptic devices in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. The discussion of FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F below is to describe exemplary mechanical coupling assemblies that can be implemented within the exemplary portable haptic devices as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C and/or FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B. However, the various exemplary mechanical coupling assemblies to be described in further detail below in FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F are not limiting, other mechanical coupling assemblies are possible that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. These exemplary mechanical coupling assemblies to be described in further detail below in FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to a seat, such the seat 210 as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C and/or the wheelchair 304 as described above in FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B. These mechanical coupling assemblies to be described in further detail below in FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F can propagate vibrations, generated by a haptic device, such as the haptic device 204 as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C and/or the haptic device 400 as described above in FIG. 4, onto the seat in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C and/or FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B. In some embodiments, these mechanical coupling assemblies to be described in further detail below in FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F can be constructed using one or more metallic elements, for example, copper, aluminum, one or more metallic compounds, one or more metallic mixtures, or alloys, such as steel to provide an example, and/or any other suitable metallic material that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, these mechanical coupling assemblies to be described in further detail below in FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F can be constructed using one or more synthetic or semi-synthetic organic compounds or materials, such as plastic and/or fiberglass to provide some examples, one or more organic materials, such as carbon fiber to provide an example, and/or any other suitable non-metallic material that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. These mechanical coupling assemblies to be described in further detail below in FIG. 5A through FIG. 5F can represent exemplary embodiments of the

mechanical coupling assembly **208** as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C.

[0030] FIG. 5A graphically illustrates a first mechanical coupling assembly **500** that can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the seat. As illustrated in FIG. 5A, the first mechanical coupling assembly **500** can be characterized as being a “U” shape, or a “U”-like shape, that attaches onto the seat, for example, by the interference fit as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C. In some embodiments, a sheet of material can be deformed, bent, or folded into the “U” shape, or the “U”-like shape, to form the first mechanical coupling assembly **500**. For example, the sheet of material can be pressed, or stamped, into the “U” shape, or the “U”-like shape to form the first mechanical coupling assembly **500**. Alternatively, or in addition to, the first mechanical coupling assembly **500** can be formed through injection molding. In some embodiments, a mold of the “U” shape, or the “U”-like shape, of the first mechanical coupling assembly **500** can be created. In these embodiments, material can be injected at pressure into the mold that solidifies to produce the first mechanical coupling assembly **500**.

[0031] FIG. 5B graphically illustrates a second mechanical coupling assembly **510** that can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the seat. The second mechanical coupling assembly **510** is substantially similar to the first mechanical coupling assembly **500** as described above in FIG. 5A. However, the second mechanical coupling assembly **510** includes one or more openings, or holes, **514** as illustrated in FIG. 5B. Generally, the one or more holes **514** represent one or more geometric regions within the second mechanical coupling assembly **510** that are free of material to, for example, reduce the weight of the second mechanical coupling assembly **510** as compared to the first mechanical coupling assembly **500**. In some embodiments, the one or more holes **514** can include regular curves, such as circles or ellipses; irregular curves; regular polygons, such as equilateral triangles or squares, irregular polygons, such as rectangles and/or parallelograms; and/or any other suitable closed geometric regions that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the one or more holes **514** can extend along a series of rows of holes and/or a series of columns of holes to form an array of holes within the second mechanical coupling assembly **510**.

[0032] FIG. 5C graphically illustrates a third mechanical coupling assembly **520** that can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the seat. The third mechanical coupling assembly **520** is substantially similar to the first mechanical coupling assembly **500** as described above in FIG. 5A. However, the third mechanical coupling assembly **520** can be characterized as being a “J” shape, or a “J”-like shape, that attaches onto the seat, for example, by the interference fit as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C.

[0033] FIG. 5D graphically illustrates a fourth mechanical coupling assembly **530** that can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the seat. The fourth mechanical coupling assembly **530** is substantially similar to the first mechanical coupling assembly **500** as described above in FIG. 5A. However, the fourth mechanical coupling assembly **530** can be characterized as being hooked shape, or hooked-like shape, that attaches onto the seat, for example, by the interference fit as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C.

[0034] FIG. 5E graphically illustrates a fifth mechanical coupling assembly **540** that can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the seat. As illustrated in FIG. 5E, the fifth mechanical coupling assembly **540** includes a securing member **542** to temporarily secure the fifth mechanical coupling assembly **540** to the seat. In some embodiments, the securing member **542** can effectively be wrapped around the seat as illustrated in FIG. 5E to temporarily secure the fifth mechanical coupling assembly **540** to the seat. The securing member **542** can be implemented with one or more mechanical fasteners, such as hook-and-loop fasteners and/or tie-down straps to provide some examples.

[0035] FIG. 5F graphically illustrates a sixth mechanical coupling assembly **550** that can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to the seat. As illustrated in FIG. 5F, the sixth

mechanical coupling assembly **550** includes a first mechanical coupling assembly **552** and a second mechanical coupling assembly **554**. In some embodiments, the first mechanical coupling assembly **552** can be mechanically coupled to the second mechanical coupling assembly **554** to form the sixth mechanical coupling assembly **550**. In some embodiments, the first mechanical coupling assembly **552** and the second mechanical coupling assembly **554** can be configured and arranged to form various interlocking connectors, such as annular snap-together connectors, cantilever snap-together connectors, torsional snap-together connectors, and the like to provide some examples, which are connected to one another by pushing the first mechanical coupling assembly **552** and the second mechanical coupling assembly **554** into each other.

Exemplary Operation of the Exemplary Portable Haptic Devices

[0036] FIG. **6** graphically illustrates a first exemplary operation of the exemplary portable haptic devices in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. **6**, a portable haptic system **600** can include a portable haptic device **602** that can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to a seat **604** in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. **2A** through FIG. **2C**. As illustrated in FIG. **6**, a portable electronic device **606** can control the operation of the portable haptic device **602** as to be described in further detail below. The portable haptic device **602** and the seat **604** can represent exemplary embodiments of the portable haptic device **200** and the seat **210**, respectively, as described above in FIG. **2A** through FIG. **2C** and/or the portable haptic device **302** and the wheelchair **304**, respectively, as described above in FIG. **3A** and FIG. **3B**.

[0037] As described above, the portable electronic device **606** can control the operation of the portable haptic device **602**. In some embodiments, the portable electronic device **606** can include a consumer electronics device, a cellular phone, a smartphone, a feature phone, a tablet computer, a wearable computer device, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a pager, a wireless handset, a desktop computer, a laptop computer, a head-up display (HUD) device, an embedded system, a microcontroller, a control module, a networked or “smart” appliance, a Machine-Type-Communication (MTC) device, a Machine-to-Machine (M2M) device, a Internet of Things (IoT) device, or the like. In some embodiments, the portable electronic device **606** can include an application program, or app for short, that, when executed by the portable electronic device **606**, can control the operation of the portable haptic device **602**. In these embodiments, a user of the portable haptic system **600**, for example, the member of the audience as described above in FIG. **2A** through FIG. **2C**, can interact with the software application using the portable electronic device **606** to control the operation of the portable haptic device **602** as to be described in further detail below.

[0038] In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. **6**, the portable electronic device **606** can store a unique identifier of the portable haptic device **602** being used by the user. In some embodiments, the unique identifier can include an Internet Protocol (IP) address of the portable haptic device **602**, a media access controller (MAC) address of the portable haptic device **602**, a model name of the portable haptic device **602**, a serial number of the portable haptic device **602**, a manufacturer name of the portable haptic device **602**, a username and/or a password of the user; and/or any other suitable unique identifier that will be recognized by those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the portable electronic device **606** can include, or reference, the unique identifier in communications to the portable haptic device **602** to allow these communications to be distinguished from other communications to other portable haptic device from other portable electronic devices.

[0039] In some embodiments, the user can interact with the portable electronic device **606** to activate, or turn-on, and/or to deactivate, or turn-off, the portable haptic device **602**. In some embodiments, the user can interact with the portable electronic device **606** to configure the portable haptic device **602**. In these embodiments, the portable electronic device **606** can be used to set

boundaries, for example, in terms of magnitude, for the vibrations generated by the portable haptic device **602**. In some embodiments, the portable electronic device **606** can display the event in real-time, or near real-time, instructions relating to the operation of the portable haptic device **602** and/or information related to the event, for example, close captioning. In these embodiments, the portable electronic device **606** can display advertisements and/or other information related to the venue, for example, a map of the venue highlighting concessions, restaurants, rest rooms, public telephones, and/or exits.

[0040] FIGS. 7A and 7B graphically illustrates a second exemplary operation of the exemplary portable haptic devices in accordance with some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. As described above, a seat within a venue, for example, one or more of the seats **106.1** through **106.f** within the venue **100** to provide an example, can be mechanically coupled, for example, attached, to a portable haptic device, such as the portable haptic device **200** as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C, the portable haptic device **302** as described above in FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B, and/or the portable haptic device **602** as described above in FIG. 6. The portable haptic device can generate vibrations at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to provide the physical sensations to the audience as the audience is viewing an event within the venue in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C. And as described above, the event can include an image or a series of images, often referred to as video, and audio that is associated with the image, or the video. The discussion of FIG. 7A to follow is to describe an exemplary event system **700** that can generate the vibrations in relation to, for example, synchronous with, the audio that is associated with the image, or the video, in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7A, the exemplary event system **700** can include an event server **702**, a video system **704**, an audio system **706**, an audio crossover system **708**, and portable haptic device systems **710**. The portable haptic device systems **710** can include one or more of the portable haptic system **212** as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C, the portable haptic device system **306** as described above in FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B, and/or the portable haptic system **600** as described above in FIG. 6.

[0041] In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7A, the event server **702** represents one or more computer systems, an exemplary embodiment of which is to be described in further detail below, which facilitate operation of the venue. In some embodiments, the event server **702** can be implemented in hardware, firmware, software, or any combination thereof. Further, firmware, software, routines, instructions, and/or applications can be described herein as performing certain actions. However, it should be appreciated that such descriptions are merely for convenience and that these actions result from computing devices, processors, controllers, or other devices executing the firmware, software, routines, instructions, and/or applications. As illustrated in FIG. 7A, the event server **702** can deliver an image or a series of images, also referred to as video, and/or audio that is associated with the image, or the video, to the video system **704** and/or to the audio system **706** for presentation to an audience within the venue. From the example above, the event server **702** can deliver video and/or audio that is associated with a thunderstorm to the video system **704** and/or to the audio system **706** for presentation to an audience within the venue.

[0042] In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7A, the video system **704** can present the image, or the video, that is received from the event server **702** to the audience within the venue. From the example above, the video system **704** can present the video that is associated with the thunderstorm that is received from the event server **702** to the audience within the venue. In some embodiments, the video system **704** can include one or more visual displays, such as one or more flat-panel devices, such as one or more liquid crystal displays (LCDs), one or more light-emitting diode (LED) displays, one or more organic light-emitting diode (OLED) displays, and/or one or more quantum dots (QDs) displays to provide some examples, one or more projection devices, and/or any other suitable electrical, mechanical, and/or electro-mechanical device for presenting

the image, or the video, that will be apparent to those skilled in the relevant art(s) without departing the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

[0043] In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7A, the audio system **706** can present the audio received from the event server **702** to the audience within the venue. From the example above, the audio system **706** can present the audio that is associated with the thunderstorm that is received from the event server **702** to the audience within the venue. Generally, the audio system **706** can include one or more auditory speakers, such as one or more super tweeters, one or more tweeters, one or more mid-range speakers, one or more woofers, one or more subwoofers, and/or one or more full-range speakers to provide some examples. In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7A, the audio system **706** can include one or more super tweeters/tweeters **712**, one or more mid-range speakers **714**, one or more woofers/subwoofers **716** to provide some examples. The one or more super tweeters/tweeters **712** deliver audio within a first audio frequency range between approximately two (2) kilohertz (kHz) and approximately twenty (20) kHz. The one or more mid-range speakers **714** deliver audio within a second audio frequency range between approximately two hundred fifty (250) Hertz (Hz) and approximately two (2) kHz. The one or more woofers/subwoofers **716** deliver audio within a third audio frequency range between approximately twenty (20) Hz and approximately two hundred fifty (250) Hz.

[0044] The audio crossover system **708** separates, or de-mixes, the audio from the event server **702** into the first audio frequency range, the second audio frequency range, and the third audio frequency range. In some embodiments, the audio crossover system **708** can include multiple filters to de-mix the audio into the first audio frequency range, the second audio frequency range, and the third audio frequency range. From the example above, the audio that is associated with the thunderstorm can include audio associated with rain falling between approximately thirteen (13) kHz and approximately twenty-five (25) kHz and audio associated with the thunder between approximately four (4) Hz and approximately one hundred twenty-five (125) Hz. In this example, the audio crossover system **708** can de-mix the audio associated with rain falling into the first audio frequency range and the audio associated with the thunder into the third audio frequency range. In some embodiments, the audio crossover system **708** can be integrated within the event server **702**. As illustrated in FIG. 7A, the audio crossover system **708** delivers the audio within the first audio frequency range to the one or more super tweeters/tweeters **712**, the audio within the second audio frequency range to the one or more mid-range speakers **714**, and the audio within the third audio frequency range to the one or more woofers/subwoofers **716** and the portable haptic device systems **710**.

[0045] In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7A, the portable haptic device systems **710** can generate vibrations in relation to, for example, synchronous with, the audio within the third audio frequency range in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device systems **710** can generate the vibrations to be synchronous with the lowest sounds of the audio, often referred to as bass sounds between approximately sixteen (16) Hz and approximately two hundred fifty-six (256) Hz to provide an example, within the third audio frequency range. From the example above, the portable haptic device systems **710** can generate vibrations between approximately four (4) Hertz (Hz) and approximately one hundred twenty-five (125) Hz to simulate the rumbling of audio of thunder as the audience is viewing the thunderstorm within the venue.

[0046] As illustrated in FIG. 7B, the portable haptic device systems **710** can include portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** that are communicatively coupled to a portable haptic device system controller **722**. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** can include portable haptic devices **726.1** through **726.i** that are attached to seats **724.1** through **724.i** in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C and/or FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B. The portable haptic devices **726.1** through **726.i** and the seats **724.1** through **724.i** can represent exemplary embodiments of the portable haptic device **200** and the seat

210, respectively, as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C, the portable haptic device **302** and the wheelchair **304**, respectively, as described above in FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B, and/or the portable haptic device **602** and the seat **604**, respectively, as described above in FIG. 6. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** can generate the vibrations in relation to, for example, synchronous with, the audio that is received from the audio crossover system **708** in a substantially similar manner as described above in FIG. 2A through FIG. 2C. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** can generate the vibrations to be synchronous with the lowest sounds of the audio, often referred to as bass sounds between approximately sixteen (16) Hz and approximately two hundred fifty-six (256) Hz to provide an example. From the example above, the portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** can generate the vibrations between four (4) Hertz (Hz) and one hundred twenty-five (125) Hz to simulate the rumbling of audio of thunder as the audience is viewing the thunderstorm within the venue. Moreover, the portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** can be mechanically and/or electrically coupled to wireline communication cables **728.1** through **728.i** to communicatively couple the portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** and the portable haptic device system controller **722**. In some embodiments, the wireline communication cables **728.1** through **728.i** can include one or more copper cables, such as one or more coaxial cables, one or more ribbon cables, one or more shielded cables, and/or one or more twinax cables to provide some examples. Alternatively, or in addition to, the wireline communication cables **728.1** through **728.i** can include one or more fiberoptic cables.

[0047] The portable haptic device system controller **722** provides the audio received from the audio crossover system **708** to the portable haptic device systems **710**. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device system controller **722** provides the audio within the third audio frequency range that is associated with the image, or the video. From the example above, the portable haptic device system controller **722** can provide the audio that is associated with the rumbling of audio of thunder that is received from the portable haptic device systems **710** to the portable haptic device systems **710**. In these embodiments, the portable haptic device system controller **722** can provide the lowest sounds of the audio that is associated with the image, or the video, often referred to as bass sounds between approximately sixteen (16) Hz and approximately two hundred fifty-six (256) Hz to provide an example. From the example above, the portable haptic device system controller **722** can provide the audio that is associated with the audio of thunder between four (4) Hertz (Hz) and one hundred twenty-five (125) Hz to the portable haptic device systems **710** to simulate the rumbling of audio of thunder as the audience is viewing the thunderstorm within the venue. Alternatively, or in addition to, the portable haptic device system controller **722** can provide electrical power necessary to operate the portable haptic device systems **710**.

[0048] In the exemplary embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7B, the portable haptic device system controller **722** can route the audio within the third audio frequency range that is associated with the image, or the video, as received from the audio crossover system **708** and/or the electrical power to the portable haptic device systems **710**. As illustrated in FIG. 7B, the portable haptic device system controller **722** can be mechanically and/or electrically coupled to portable haptic device hubs **730.1** through **730.i** via wireline communication cables **732.1** through **732.i**. In some embodiments, the wireline communication cables **732.1** through **732.i** can include one or more copper cables, such as one or more coaxial cables, one or more ribbon cables, one or more shielded cables, and/or one or more twinax cables to provide some examples. Alternatively, or in addition to, the wireline communication cables **732.1** through **732.i** can include one or more fiberoptic cables. The portable haptic device hubs **730.1** through **730.i** represent receptacles for mechanically and/or electrically coupling the portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** and the portable haptic device system controller **722**. In some embodiments, the portable haptic device hubs **730.1** through **730.i** can be situated within, or proximate to, one or more wheelchair accessible seating locations within the venue as described above in FIG. 1. In some embodiments, the wireline communication cables

728.1 through **728.i** can be coupled, for example, connected, to the portable haptic device hubs **730.1** through **730.i** to mechanically and/or electrically couple their corresponding portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** to the portable haptic device system controller **722**. In these embodiments, the wireline communication cables **728.1** through **728.i** can be connected to the portable haptic device hubs **730.1** through **730.i** at the start of the event. In some embodiments, the wireline communication cables **728.1** through **728.i** can be decoupled, for example, disconnected, from the portable haptic device hubs **730.1** through **730.i** to mechanically and/or electrically decouple their corresponding portable haptic device systems **720.1** through **720.i** from the portable haptic device system controller **722**. In these embodiments, the wireline communication cables **728.1** through **728.i** can be disconnected to the portable haptic device hubs **730.1** through **730.i** at the conclusion of the event.

Exemplary Computer System that can be Utilized to Implement Electronic Devices within the Exemplary Venue

[0049] FIG. **8** graphically illustrates a simplified block diagram of a computer system that can be utilized to implement electronic devices within the exemplary venue according to some embodiments of the present disclosure. The discussion of FIG. **8** to follow is to describe a computer system **800** that can be used to implement the portable haptic device system controller **722** as described above in FIG. **7B**.

[0050] In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **8**, the computer system **800** includes one or more processors **802**. In some embodiments, the one or more processors **802** can include, or can be, any of a microprocessor, graphics processing unit, or digital signal processor, and their electronic processing equivalents, such as an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (“ASIC”) or Field Programmable Gate Array (“FPGA”). As used herein, the term “processor” signifies a tangible data and information processing device that physically transforms data and information, typically using a sequence transformation (also referred to as “operations”). Data and information can be physically represented by an electrical, magnetic, optical or acoustical signal that is capable of being stored, accessed, transferred, combined, compared, or otherwise manipulated by the processor. The term “processor” can signify a singular processor and multi-core systems or multi-processor arrays, including graphic processing units, digital signal processors, digital processors or combinations of these elements. The processor can be electronic, for example, comprising digital logic circuitry (for example, binary logic), or analog (for example, an operational amplifier). The processor may also operate to support performance of the relevant operations in a “cloud computing” environment or as a “software as a service” (SaaS). For example, at least some of the operations may be performed by a group of processors available at a distributed or remote system, these processors accessible via a communications network (e.g., the Internet) and via one or more software interfaces (e.g., an application program interface (API).) In some embodiments, the computer system **800** can include an operating system, such as Microsoft's Windows, Sun Microsystems's Solaris, Apple Computer's MacOs, Linux or UNIX. In some embodiments, the computer system **800** can also include a Basic Input/Output System (BIOS) and processor firmware. The operating system, BIOS and firmware are used by the one or more processors **802** to control subsystems and interfaces coupled to the one or more processors **802**. In some embodiments, the one or more processors **802** can include the Pentium and Itanium from Intel, the Opteron and Athlon from Advanced Micro Devices, and the ARM processor from ARM Holdings.

[0051] As illustrated in FIG. **8**, the computer system **800** can include a machine-readable medium **804**. In some embodiments, the machine-readable medium **804** can further include a main random-access memory (“RAM”) **806**, a read only memory (“ROM”) **808**, and/or a file storage subsystem **810**. The RAM **730** can store instructions and data during program execution and the ROM **732** can store fixed instructions. The file storage subsystem **810** provides persistent storage for program and data files, and may include a hard disk drive, a floppy disk drive along with associated removable media, a CD-ROM drive, an optical drive, a flash memory, or removable media cartridges.

[0052] The computer system **800** can further include user interface input devices **812** and user interface output devices **814**. The user interface input devices **812** can include an alphanumeric keyboard, a keypad, pointing devices such as a mouse, trackball, touchpad, stylus, or graphics tablet, a scanner, a touchscreen incorporated into the display, audio input devices such as voice recognition systems or microphones, eye-gaze recognition, brainwave pattern recognition, and other types of input devices to provide some examples. The user interface input devices **812** can be connected by wire or wirelessly to the computer system **800**. Generally, the user interface input devices **812** are intended to include all possible types of devices and ways to input information into the computer system **800**. The user interface input devices **812** typically allow a user to identify objects, icons, text and the like that appear on some types of user interface output devices, for example, a display subsystem. The user interface output devices **820** may include a display subsystem, a printer, a fax machine, or non-visual displays such as audio output devices. The display subsystem may include a cathode ray tube (CRT), a flat-panel device such as a liquid crystal display (LCD), a projection device, or some other device for creating a visible image such as a virtual reality system. The display subsystem may also provide non-visual display such as via audio output or tactile output (e.g., vibrations) devices. Generally, the user interface output devices **820** are intended to include all possible types of devices and ways to output information from the computer system **800**.

[0053] The computer system **800** can further include a network interface **816** to provide an interface to outside networks, including an interface to a communication network **818**, and is coupled via the communication network **818** to corresponding interface devices in other computer systems or machines. The communication network **818** may comprise many interconnected computer systems, machines and communication links. These communication links may be wired links, optical links, wireless links, or any other devices for communication of information. The communication network **818** can be any suitable computer network, for example a wide area network such as the Internet, and/or a local area network such as Ethernet. The communication network **818** can be wired and/or wireless, and the communication network can use encryption and decryption methods, such as is available with a virtual private network. The communication network uses one or more communications interfaces, which can receive data from, and transmit data to, other systems. Embodiments of communications interfaces typically include an Ethernet card, a modem (e.g., telephone, satellite, cable, or ISDN), (asynchronous) digital subscriber line (DSL) unit, Firewire interface, USB interface, and the like. One or more communications protocols can be used, such as HTTP, TCP/IP, RTP/RTSP, IPX and/or UDP.

[0054] As illustrated in FIG. **8**, the one or more processors **802**, the machine-readable medium **804**, the user interface input devices **812**, the user interface output devices **814**, and/or the network interface **816** can be communicatively coupled to one another using a bus subsystem **820**. Although the bus subsystem **820** is shown schematically as a single bus, alternative embodiments of the bus subsystem may use multiple busses. For example, RAM-based main memory can communicate directly with file storage systems using Direct Memory Access (“DMA”) systems.

CONCLUSION

[0055] The Detailed Description referred to accompanying figures to illustrate exemplary embodiments consistent with the disclosure. References in the disclosure to “an exemplary embodiment” indicates that the exemplary embodiment described can include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every exemplary embodiment may not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same exemplary embodiment. Further, any feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with an exemplary embodiment can be included, independently or in any combination, with features, structures, or characteristics of other exemplary embodiments whether or not explicitly described.

[0056] The Detailed Description is not meant to limiting. Rather, the scope of the disclosure is

defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents. It is to be appreciated that the Detailed Description section, and not the Abstract section, is intended to be used to interpret the claims. The Abstract section can set forth one or more, but not all exemplary embodiments, of the disclosure, and thus, are not intended to limit the disclosure and the following claims and their equivalents in any way.

[0057] The exemplary embodiments described within the disclosure have been provided for illustrative purposes and are not intended to be limiting. Other exemplary embodiments are possible, and modifications can be made to the exemplary embodiments while remaining within the spirit and scope of the disclosure. The disclosure has been described with the aid of functional building blocks illustrating the implementation of specified functions and relationships thereof. The boundaries of these functional building blocks have been arbitrarily defined herein for the convenience of the description. Alternate boundaries can be defined so long as the specified functions and relationships thereof are appropriately performed.

[0058] Embodiments of the disclosure can be implemented in hardware, firmware, software application, or any combination thereof. Embodiments of the disclosure can also be implemented as instructions stored on a machine-readable medium, which can be read and executed by one or more processors. A machine-readable medium can include any mechanism for storing or transmitting information in a form readable by a machine (e.g., a computing circuitry). For example, a machine-readable medium can include non-transitory machine-readable mediums such as read only memory (ROM); random access memory (RAM); magnetic disk storage media; optical storage media; flash memory devices; and others. As another example, the machine-readable medium can include transitory machine-readable medium such as electrical, optical, acoustical, or other forms of propagated signals (e.g., carrier waves, infrared signals, digital signals, etc.). Further, firmware, software application, routines, instructions can be described herein as performing certain actions. However, it should be appreciated that such descriptions are merely for convenience and that such actions in fact result from computing devices, processors, controllers, or other devices executing the firmware, software application, routines, instructions, etc.

[0059] The Detailed Description of the exemplary embodiments fully revealed the general nature of the disclosure that others can, by applying knowledge of those skilled in relevant art(s), readily modify and/or adapt for various applications such exemplary embodiments, without undue experimentation, without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure. Therefore, such adaptations and modifications are intended to be within the meaning and plurality of equivalents of the exemplary embodiments based upon the teaching and guidance presented herein. It is to be understood that the phraseology or terminology herein is for the purpose of description and not of limitation, such that the terminology or phraseology of the present specification is to be interpreted by those skilled in relevant art(s) in light of the teachings herein.

Claims

1. A portable haptic device, comprising: a haptic device configured to generate one or more vibrations; and a mechanical coupling assembly configured to: slide onto a back of a seat without suffering any permanent damage to the seat, the mechanical coupling assembly being held to the seat by friction once the mechanical coupling assembly is slid onto the back of the seat, propagate the one or more vibrations generated by the haptic device onto an audience member seated within the seat, and slide from the back of the seat without suffering any permanent damage to the seat.
2. The portable haptic device of claim 1, wherein the haptic device is configured to generate the one or more vibrations at one or more frequencies over one or more intervals in time, and wherein the mechanical coupling assembly is configured to vibrate at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to propagate the one or more vibrations generated by the haptic device onto the audience member.

3. The portable haptic device of claim 2, wherein the portable haptic device is incorporated within a venue, and wherein the haptic device is configured to generate the one or more vibrations at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to provide physical sensations to the audience member as the audience member is viewing an event being hosted at the venue.
4. The portable haptic device of claim 3, wherein the one or more frequencies comprise one or more frequencies between approximately sixteen Hertz (Hz) and approximately two hundred fifty-six Hz.
5. The portable haptic device of claim 1, wherein the mechanical coupling assembly and the seat are configured and arranged to form a mechanical joint that enables the portable haptic device to slide onto the back of the seat and to be held to the seat by the friction once the mechanical coupling assembly is slid onto the back of the seat.
6. The portable haptic device of claim 1, further comprising a securing member configured to be wrapped around the back of the seat to temporarily secure the portable haptic device to the seat.
7. The portable haptic device of claim 1, wherein the seat comprises a wheelchair.
8. A method for operating a wheelchair positioned within an Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) compliant seating location within a venue, the method comprising: sliding a portable haptic device onto a back of the wheelchair prior to the event without suffering any permanent damage to the wheelchair, the mechanical coupling assembly being held to the wheelchair by friction once the mechanical coupling assembly is slid onto the back of the wheelchair; propagating one or more vibrations generated by the portable haptic device onto an audience member seated within the wheelchair during the event; and sliding the portable haptic device from the back of the wheelchair after the event without suffering any permanent damage to the wheelchair.
9. The method of claim 8, wherein the propagating comprises generating the one or more vibrations at one or more frequencies over one or more intervals in time.
10. The method of claim 9, wherein the generating comprises generating the one or more vibrations at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to provide physical sensations to the audience member as the audience member is viewing the event.
11. The method of claim 9, wherein the one or more frequencies comprise one or more frequencies between approximately sixteen Hertz (Hz) and approximately two hundred fifty-six Hz.
12. The method of claim 8, wherein the sliding the portable haptic device onto the back of the wheelchair comprises forming a mechanical joint that enables the portable haptic device to slide onto the back of the wheelchair and to be held to the wheelchair by the friction once the portable haptic device is slid onto the back of the wheelchair.
13. The method of claim 8, further comprising wrapping a securing member around the back of the wheelchair to temporarily secure the portable haptic device to the wheelchair.
14. A venue for hosting an event, the venue comprising: a plurality of seating locations for viewing the event, at least one seating location from among the plurality of seating locations being an Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) compliant seating location to accommodate a wheelchair positioned within the ADA-compliant seating location; and a portable haptic device configured to: slide onto a back of the wheelchair without suffering any permanent damage to the wheelchair, the portable haptic device being held to the wheelchair by friction once the portable haptic device is slid onto the back of the wheelchair, propagate one or more vibrations generated by the portable haptic device onto an audience member seated within the wheelchair, and slide from the back of the wheelchair without suffering any permanent damage to the wheelchair.
15. The venue of claim 14, wherein the portable haptic device is configured to generate the one or more vibrations at one or more frequencies over one or more intervals in time.
16. The venue of claim 15, wherein the portable haptic device is configured to generate the one or more vibrations at the one or more frequencies over the one or more intervals in time to provide physical sensations to the audience member as the audience member is viewing an event being hosted at the venue.

- 17.** The venue of claim 16, wherein the one or more frequencies comprise one or more frequencies between approximately sixteen Hertz (Hz) and approximately two hundred fifty-six Hz.
- 18.** The venue of claim 14, wherein the portable haptic device and the wheelchair are configured and arranged to form a mechanical joint that enables the portable haptic device to slide onto the back of the wheelchair and to be held to the wheelchair by the friction once the mechanical coupling assembly is slid onto the back of the wheelchair.
- 19.** The venue of claim 14, wherein the portable haptic device comprises a securing member configured to be wrapped around the back of the wheelchair to temporarily secure the portable haptic device to the wheelchair.
- 20.** The venue of claim 14, wherein the ADA-compliant seating location positioned among the plurality of seating locations to allow the audience member to view the event while seated in the wheelchair.
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